STORY-008 Compliance Matrix Validation: evidence

STORY-008 works on the demo deployment, with synthetic data; it is not operating in production. Every exemption decision is checked against 8 decision controls at the moment a case manager approves or denies it. A decision that fails any control opens a compliance review that only a different case manager can resolve, with a written justification: accept the exception (recorded as an override in the audit log) or reopen the case (back to In Review, with the applicant notified). The results feed a compliance dashboard with a 99% target and an alert below it, and a filterable audit log of every control result.

Screens 1 to 8 come from an automated run that seeds synthetic cases through the API, resolves the review through the real UI in headless Chrome and checks what each screen shows. It ran locally on the code now deployed to the demo site (commits ac9dab3 and 6500c38), because the demo site has no test case-manager accounts. Screens 9 and 10 are the deployed demo site.

Checks

- Demo deployment (scripts/verify-deploy.mjs): the API serves 50e0769 and the site e302dbf, the newest change to each; database ok; 13 migrations applied; all 27 protected GET routes answer 401 without a token.
- On the demo deployment, signed in as a synthetic citizen (scripts/verify-live-citizen.mjs): all 15 staff GET routes answer 403; the control list is readable; no Compliance link.
- UI run (scripts/evidence/story-008.mjs): 16 checks passed while capturing screens 1 to 8, with the review resolved through the real UI.
- API end to end, local (scripts/e2e): 87 checks passed: access 31, case workflow 26, compliance 30.
- Unit tests: 154 passed, including 133 route-access checks and 13 compliance-control tests.

Screens

1. Compliance dashboard: below target, one open review
2. The deciding manager sees what failed and cannot clear it
3. A second case manager must justify the outcome
4. Case reopened
5. Decided again, compliantly; the failed decision stays on record
6. Compliance audit log
7. Dashboard after the review
8. What the applicant sees
9. Demo site: a citizen's dashboard
10. Demo site: a citizen opening /compliance

Notes

- The controls: CTRL-01 the approval matches a current eligibility determination; CTRL-02 eligibility was re-checked after the applicant's last profile change (Privacy Act, 5 U.S.C. 552a(e)(5)); CTRL-03 a denial records its reason and notifies the applicant (APA, 5 U.S.C. 555(e)); CTRL-04 the decider is not the applicant (NIST SP 800-53 AC-5); CTRL-05 the case is assigned to the case manager who decides it; CTRL-06 the decision is made from In Review; CTRL-07 the required document is on file (proof of age, income statement or hardship evidence); CTRL-08 the decision is in the audit log with who, what and when (NIST SP 800-53 AU-3).
- Decisions made before this release have no control results, so the demo dashboard starts empty and fills as cases are decided.
- Known gap, before any real data: the case-manager role is granted from an email list on the server without verifying that the person owns the address. Staff roles need verified identities (email verification or admin-assigned roles) before production.
- All data shown is synthetic.

1. Compliance dashboard: below target, one open review

Sam Ortiz, a case manager, opens Compliance. One of the three decisions so far failed two controls, so the rate is 66.67% against the 99% target and the alert is raised. The failing decision is listed under Open reviews with the controls it failed.

Compliance

Every exemption decision checked against the decision controls

Dashboard | Profile & Exemptions | Case Management | Compliance | Logout

Demo environment. Synthetic data only. Do not enter a real SSN.

Last 7 days | **Last 30 days** | Last 90 days

Open the compliance audit log →

Below target

Compliance rate 66.67% is below the 99% target for the last 30 days. Decisions still waiting for a second case manager are listed under Open reviews.

Decisions (last 30 days)	Passed every control	Compliance rate	Open reviews
3	2	66.67%	1
		Target 99%	

Open reviews

Decisions that failed a control. A different case manager resolves each one from the case page.

Jordan Rivera · Type A · Approved by dana.whitfield@example.com
Failed: CTRL-05 Accountable reviewer; CTRL-07 Supporting evidence on file
Opened 10/6/2026, 2:35:57 AM

Review on case →

Decision controls

Checked automatically whenever a case manager approves or denies a case.

Control	Requirement and reference	Applies to	Checked	Failed
CTRL-01 An approval matches a current Eligible or Pending Review determination	Decision follows the eligibility rules Program rules (STORY-006)	Approved	2	0
CTRL-02 Eligibility was re-checked after the applicant's last profile change	Accurate, timely records for determinations Privacy Act, 5 U.S.C. 552a(e)(5)	Approved, Denied	3	0
CTRL-03 A denial records its reason and the applicant is notified	Statement of grounds for denial Administrative Procedure Act, 5 U.S.C. 555(e)	Denied	1	0
CTRL-04 The decider is not the applicant	Separation of duties NIST SP 800-53 AC-5	Approved, Denied	3	0
CTRL-05 The case is assigned to the case manager who decides it	Accountable reviewer Program policy	Approved, Denied	3	1
CTRL-06 The decision is made from In Review	Review before decision Program policy (STORY-007 workflow)	Approved, Denied	3	0
CTRL-07 An approval has its supporting document: proof of age (A), income statement (B) or hardship evidence (C)	Supporting evidence on file Program policy	Approved	2	1
CTRL-08 The decision is in the audit log with who, what and when	Audit record content NIST SP 800-53 AU-3	Approved, Denied	3	0

Decisions by day

2026-10-06 — 2/3 compliant

2. The deciding manager sees what failed and cannot clear it

Dana Whitfield approved Jordan Rivera's case while it was unassigned and without proof of age. The case page shows CTRL-05 and CTRL-07 failed, with the evidence for every control. The deciding manager cannot resolve a review of their own decision (NIST AC-5), and the API refuses it as well.

Exemption Case
Status, timeline, and documents

Dashboard | Profile & Exemptions | Case Management | Compliance | Logout

Demo environment. Synthetic data only. Do not enter a real SSN.

← All cases

Type A case

Approved

Jordan Rivera · jordan.rivera@example.com

Submitted	Last updated	Assigned to	Approved
10/6/2026, 2:35:57 AM	10/6/2026, 2:35:57 AM	Unassigned	10/6/2026, 2:35:57 AM

Eligibility check: Eligible Applicant is 65 or older.

Timeline

Application submitted
10/6/2026, 2:35:57 AM · jordan.rivera@example.com

Status changed: Submitted → In Review
10/6/2026, 2:35:57 AM · dana.whitfield@example.com

Status changed: In Review → Approved
10/6/2026, 2:35:57 AM · dana.whitfield@example.com

Compliance

Decision controls, checked automatically. Visible to case managers only.

Compliance review open
The approval by dana.whitfield@example.com failed CTRL-05, CTRL-07.
A different case manager must resolve a review of your own decision.

Latest decision: **Approved** by dana.whitfield@example.com Controls failed

- ✓ CTRL-01 An approval matches a current Eligible or Pending Review determination
  Type A determination at decision: Eligible (Applicant is 65 or older.)
- ✓ CTRL-02 Eligibility was re-checked after the applicant's last profile change
  Eligibility determined 2026-10-06 07:35:57 UTC; profile last changed 2026-10-06 07:35:56 UTC
- ✓ CTRL-04 The decider is not the applicant
  Decided by dana.whitfield@example.com, not the applicant
- ✗ CTRL-05 **The case is assigned to the case manager who decides it**
  Assigned to nobody; decided by dana.whitfield@example.com
- ✓ CTRL-06 The decision is made from In Review
  Moved from In Review to Approved
- ✗ CTRL-07 **An approval has its supporting document: proof of age (A), income statement (B) or hardship evidence (C)**
  Requires proof_of_age; on file: none
- ✓ CTRL-08 The decision is in the audit log with who, what and when
  CASE_STATUS_CHANGE audit entry recorded for this decision

Assignment

Unassigned

Save | Assign to me

Documents

No documents yet.

Proof of age

https://link-to-your-document

Add document link

Attach a link to the document. Direct file upload arrives with cloud storage.

Internal Notes

Visible to case managers only.

Add a note for the case team

Add note

3. A second case manager must justify the outcome

Sam opens the same case. A written justification is required before either action: Accept exception (recorded as an override in the audit log) or Reopen case.

Exemption Case
Status, timeline, and documents

Dashboard | Profile & Exemptions | Case Management | Compliance | Logout

Demo environment. Synthetic data only. Do not enter a real SSN.

← All cases

Type A case

Approved

Jordan Rivera · jordan.rivera@example.com

Submitted	Last updated	Assigned to	Approved
10/6/2026, 2:35:57 AM	10/6/2026, 2:35:57 AM	Unassigned	10/6/2026, 2:35:57 AM

Eligibility check: Eligible Applicant is 65 or older.

Timeline

Application submitted
10/6/2026, 2:35:57 AM · jordan.rivera@example.com

Status changed: Submitted → In Review
10/6/2026, 2:35:57 AM · dana.whitfield@example.com

Status changed: In Review → Approved
10/6/2026, 2:35:57 AM · dana.whitfield@example.com

Compliance

Decision controls, checked automatically. Visible to case managers only.

Compliance review open

The approval by dana.whitfield@example.com failed CTRL-05, CTRL-07.

Justification (required, kept in the audit trail)

Approved without proof of age and without an assigned reviewer. Reopening so the applicant can provide it.

Accept exception | Reopen case

Latest decision: **Approved** by dana.whitfield@example.com Controls failed

- ✓ CTRL-01 An approval matches a current Eligible or Pending Review determination
  Type A determination at decision: Eligible (Applicant is 65 or older.)
- ✓ CTRL-02 Eligibility was re-checked after the applicant's last profile change
  Eligibility determined 2026-10-06 07:35:57 UTC; profile last changed 2026-10-06 07:35:56 UTC
- ✓ CTRL-04 The decider is not the applicant
  Decided by dana.whitfield@example.com, not the applicant
- ✗ CTRL-05 **The case is assigned to the case manager who decides it**
  Assigned to nobody; decided by dana.whitfield@example.com
- ✓ CTRL-06 The decision is made from In Review
  Moved from In Review to Approved
- ✗ CTRL-07 **An approval has its supporting document: proof of age (A), income statement (B) or hardship evidence (C)**
  Requires proof_of_age; on file: none
- ✓ CTRL-08 The decision is in the audit log with who, what and when
  CASE_STATUS_CHANGE audit entry recorded for this decision

Assignment

Unassigned

Save | Assign to me

Documents

No documents yet.

Proof of age

https://link-to-your-document

Add document link

Attach a link to the document. Direct file upload arrives with cloud storage.

Internal Notes

Visible to case managers only.

Add a note for the case team

Add note

4. Case reopened

Sam reopens the case. Its status returns to In Review, the timeline records why, the applicant is notified, and the review closes with Sam's note.

Exemption Case
Status, timeline, and documents

Dashboard | Profile & Exemptions | Case Management | Compliance | Logout

Demo environment. Synthetic data only. Do not enter a real SSN.

← All cases

Case reopened for review.

Type A case

In Review

Jordan Rivera · jordan.rivera@example.com

Submitted	Last updated	Assigned to	Approved
10/6/2026, 2:35:57 AM	10/6/2026, 2:36:01 AM	Unassigned	—

Eligibility check: Eligible Applicant is 65 or older.

Timeline

Application submitted
10/6/2026, 2:35:57 AM · jordan.rivera@example.com

Status changed: Submitted → In Review
10/6/2026, 2:35:57 AM · dana.whitfield@example.com

Status changed: In Review → Approved
10/6/2026, 2:35:57 AM · dana.whitfield@example.com

Status changed: Approved → In Review
Reason: Reopened after a compliance review
10/6/2026, 2:36:01 AM · sam.ortiz@example.com

Compliance

Decision controls, checked automatically. Visible to case managers only.

Latest decision: **Approved** by dana.whitfield@example.com Controls failed

- ✓ CTRL-01 An approval matches a current Eligible or Pending Review determination
  Type A determination at decision: Eligible (Applicant is 65 or older.)
- ✓ CTRL-02 Eligibility was re-checked after the applicant's last profile change
  Eligibility determined 2026-10-06 07:35:57 UTC; profile last changed 2026-10-06 07:35:56 UTC
- ✓ CTRL-04 The decider is not the applicant
  Decided by dana.whitfield@example.com, not the applicant
- ✗ CTRL-05 **The case is assigned to the case manager who decides it**
  Assigned to nobody; decided by dana.whitfield@example.com
- ✓ CTRL-06 The decision is made from In Review
  Moved from In Review to Approved
- ✗ CTRL-07 **An approval has its supporting document: proof of age (A), income statement (B) or hardship evidence (C)**
  Requires proof_of_age; on file: none
- ✓ CTRL-08 The decision is in the audit log with who, what and when
  CASE_STATUS_CHANGE audit entry recorded for this decision

Review of the approval by dana.whitfield@example.com (failed CTRL-05, CTRL-07): case reopened by sam.ortiz@example.com on 10/6/2026. "Approved without proof of age and without an assigned reviewer. Reopening so the applicant can provide it."

Actions

Reason (required to deny; shown to the applicant)

Approve | Deny

Assignment

Unassigned

Save | Assign to me

Documents

No documents yet.

Proof of age

https://link-to-your-document

Add document link

Attach a link to the document. Direct file upload arrives with cloud storage.

Internal Notes

Visible to case managers only.

Add a note for the case team

Add note

5. Decided again, compliantly; the failed decision stays on record

Jordan adds proof of age; Sam takes the case (Assign to me) and approves it from the case page. All 7 controls that apply to an approval pass. The earlier failed decision and its review remain visible.

Exemption Case
Status, timeline, and documents

Dashboard | Profile & Exemptions | Case Management | Compliance | Logout

Demo environment. Synthetic data only. Do not enter a real SSN.

← All cases

Case moved to Approved.

Type A case

Approved

Jordan Rivera · jordan.rivera@example.com

Submitted	Last updated	Assigned to	Approved
10/6/2026, 2:35:57 AM	10/6/2026, 2:36:03 AM	sam.ortiz@example.com	10/6/2026, 2:36:03 AM

Eligibility check: Eligible Applicant is 65 or older.

Timeline

Application submitted
10/6/2026, 2:35:57 AM · jordan.rivera@example.com

Status changed: Submitted → In Review
10/6/2026, 2:35:57 AM · dana.whitfield@example.com

Status changed: In Review → Approved
10/6/2026, 2:35:57 AM · dana.whitfield@example.com

Status changed: Approved → In Review
Reason: Reopened after a compliance review
10/6/2026, 2:36:01 AM · sam.ortiz@example.com

Document added: Proof of age
10/6/2026, 2:36:02 AM · jordan.rivera@example.com

Assigned to sam.ortiz@example.com
10/6/2026, 2:36:02 AM · sam.ortiz@example.com

Status changed: In Review → Approved
10/6/2026, 2:36:03 AM · sam.ortiz@example.com

Assignment

Sam Ortiz (sam.ortiz@example.com)

Save | Assign to me

Documents

Proof of age
jordan.rivera@example.com · 10/6/2026, 2:36:02 AM

Proof of age

https://link-to-your-document

Add document link

Attach a link to the document. Direct file upload arrives with cloud storage.

Compliance

Decision controls, checked automatically. Visible to case managers only.

Latest decision: **Approved** by sam.ortiz@example.com All controls passed

- ✓ CTRL-01 An approval matches a current Eligible or Pending Review determination
  Type A determination at decision: Eligible (Applicant is 65 or older.)
- ✓ CTRL-02 Eligibility was re-checked after the applicant's last profile change
  Eligibility determined 2026-10-06 07:35:57 UTC; profile last changed 2026-10-06 07:35:56 UTC
- ✓ CTRL-04 The decider is not the applicant
  Decided by sam.ortiz@example.com, not the applicant
- ✓ CTRL-05 The case is assigned to the case manager who decides it
  Assigned to sam.ortiz@example.com; decided by sam.ortiz@example.com
- ✓ CTRL-06 The decision is made from In Review
  Moved from In Review to Approved
- ✓ CTRL-07 An approval has its supporting document: proof of age (A), income statement (B) or hardship evidence (C)
  Requires proof_of_age; on file: proof_of_age
- ✓ CTRL-08 The decision is in the audit log with who, what and when
  CASE_STATUS_CHANGE audit entry recorded for this decision

▼ 1 earlier decision

Approved by dana.whitfield@example.com · 10/6/2026, 2:35:57 AM · not compliant

- ✓ CTRL-01 An approval matches a current Eligible or Pending Review determination
  Type A determination at decision: Eligible (Applicant is 65 or older.)
- ✓ CTRL-02 Eligibility was re-checked after the applicant's last profile change
  Eligibility determined 2026-10-06 07:35:57 UTC; profile last changed 2026-10-06 07:35:56 UTC
- ✓ CTRL-04 The decider is not the applicant
  Decided by dana.whitfield@example.com, not the applicant
- ✗ CTRL-05 **The case is assigned to the case manager who decides it**
  Assigned to nobody; decided by dana.whitfield@example.com
- ✓ CTRL-06 The decision is made from In Review
  Moved from In Review to Approved
- ✗ CTRL-07 **An approval has its supporting document: proof of age (A), income statement (B) or hardship evidence (C)**
  Requires proof_of_age; on file: none
- ✓ CTRL-08 The decision is in the audit log with who, what and when
  CASE_STATUS_CHANGE audit entry recorded for this decision

Review of the approval by dana.whitfield@example.com (failed CTRL-05, CTRL-07): case reopened by sam.ortiz@example.com on 10/6/2026. "Approved without proof of age and without an assigned reviewer. Reopening so the applicant can provide it."

Internal Notes

Visible to case managers only.

Add a note for the case team

Add note

6. Compliance audit log

Every control result for every decision, filterable by date range, applicant or decider, decision, control and result. Filtered here to failures: the two failed checks from the first decision.

Compliance Audit Log

Every control result for every exemption decision

Dashboard | Profile & Exemptions | Case Management | Compliance | Logout

Demo environment. Synthetic data only. Do not enter a real SSN.

← Compliance dashboard

From: mm/dd/yyyy | To: mm/dd/yyyy | Applicant or decider: Email | Decision: All | Requirement: All | Result: Failed | Search | Reset

Checked	Applicant	Decision	Requirement	Result	Evidence
10/6/2026, 2:35:57 AM	Jordan Rivera jordan.rivera@example.com · Type A	Approved by dana.whitfield@example.com	CTRL-05 The case is assigned to the case manager who decides it Program policy	Failed	Assigned to nobody; decided by dana.whitfield@example.com
10/6/2026, 2:35:57 AM	Jordan Rivera jordan.rivera@example.com · Type A	Approved by dana.whitfield@example.com	CTRL-07 An approval has its supporting document: proof of age (A), income statement (B) or hardship evidence (C) Program policy	Failed	Requires proof_of_age; on file: none

2 checks

Previous | Page 1 of 1 | Next

7. Dashboard after the review

No open reviews remain. The failed decision still counts in the rate (3 of 4, 75%), so the record cannot be cleaned up after the fact.

Compliance

Every exemption decision checked against the decision controls

Dashboard | Profile & Exemptions | Case Management | Compliance | Logout

Demo environment. Synthetic data only. Do not enter a real SSN.

Last 7 days | Last 30 days | Last 90 days

Open the compliance audit log →

Below target

Compliance rate 75% is below the 99% target for the last 30 days. Every failed decision has been reviewed. They still count here, so the record stays complete.

Decisions (last 30 days)	Passed every control	Compliance rate	Open reviews
4	3	75%	0
		Target 99%	

Open reviews

Decisions that failed a control. A different case manager resolves each one from the case page.

No open reviews.

Decision controls

Checked automatically whenever a case manager approves or denies a case.

Control	Requirement and reference	Applies to	Checked	Failed
CTRL-01 An approval matches a current Eligible or Pending Review determination	Decision follows the eligibility rules Program rules (STORY-006)	Approved	3	0
CTRL-02 Eligibility was re-checked after the applicant's last profile change	Accurate, timely records for determinations Privacy Act, 5 U.S.C. 552a(e)(5)	Approved, Denied	4	0
CTRL-03 A denial records its reason and the applicant is notified	Statement of grounds for denial Administrative Procedure Act, 5 U.S.C. 555(e)	Denied	1	0
CTRL-04 The decider is not the applicant	Separation of duties NIST SP 800-53 AC-5	Approved, Denied	4	0
CTRL-05 The case is assigned to the case manager who decides it	Accountable reviewer Program policy	Approved, Denied	4	1
CTRL-06 The decision is made from In Review	Review before decision Program policy (STORY-007 workflow)	Approved, Denied	4	0
CTRL-07 An approval has its supporting document: proof of age (A), income statement (B) or hardship evidence (C)	Supporting evidence on file Program policy	Approved	3	1
CTRL-08 The decision is in the audit log with who, what and when	Audit record content NIST SP 800-53 AU-3	Approved, Denied	4	0

Decisions by day

2026-10-06 — 3/4 compliant

8. What the applicant sees

Jordan sees the status, the reason the case was reopened and the new approval, but no compliance panel or Compliance link. The compliance API returns 403 to applicants.

Exemption Case
Status, timeline, and documents

Dashboard Profile & Exemptions Logout

Demo environment. Synthetic data only. Do not enter a real SSN.

← My profile

Type A case
Your application

Approved

Submitted	Last updated	Assigned to	Approved
10/6/2026, 2:35:57 AM	10/6/2026, 2:36:03 AM	sam.ortiz@example.com	10/6/2026, 2:36:03 AM

Eligibility check: Eligible Applicant is 65 or older.

Timeline

Application submitted
10/6/2026, 2:35:57 AM · jordan.rivera@example.com

Status changed: Submitted → In Review
10/6/2026, 2:35:57 AM · dana.whitfield@example.com

Status changed: In Review → Approved
10/6/2026, 2:35:57 AM · dana.whitfield@example.com

Status changed: Approved → In Review
Reason: Reopened after a compliance review
10/6/2026, 2:36:01 AM · sam.ortiz@example.com

Document added: Proof of age
10/6/2026, 2:36:02 AM · jordan.rivera@example.com

Status changed: In Review → Approved
10/6/2026, 2:36:03 AM · sam.ortiz@example.com

Documents

Proof of age
jordan.rivera@example.com · 10/6/2026, 2:36:02 AM

Proof of age

https://link-to-your-document

Add document link

Attach a link to the document. Direct file upload arrives with cloud storage.

9. Demo site: a citizen's dashboard

https://sss-demo-frontend.onrender.com after the deploy, signed in as a synthetic citizen: compliance validation shows as done and there is no Compliance link.

SSS Modernization
Platform Dashboard

Dashboard | Profile & Exemptions | Logout

Demo environment. Synthetic data only. Do not enter a real SSN.

Welcome
Deploy Check

Status
Active

Member Since
10/6/2026

Current release
R1

D

Deploy Check

Email
deploy-check@example.com

Status
Active

Notifications

No notifications yet.

Dashboard Overview

Welcome to the SSS Modernization Platform. Release One (R1) is in progress: exemption eligibility, case management and compliance validation are live.

ℹ️ **Getting started:** check your exemption eligibility and apply from Profile & Exemptions. You can follow each application, and any decision with its reason, from its case page.

Quick Stats

Release Zero
Complete

API Status
✓

Database
✓

Frontend
✓

Release Progress

- ✓ R0: Secure registration and sign-in (hashed passwords and SSNs)
- ✓ R0: Compliance guards (demo-data banner, masked SSN entry)
- ✓ R0: Live deployment with managed database
- ✓ R1: Profile update with compliance check, and exemption eligibility with reasons
- ✓ R1: Case management: applications, review workflow, timeline, notifications, CSV export
- ✓ R1: Compliance validation: every decision checked against 8 controls, with reviews and an audit log
- → R1 (next): Data freshness, audit logging, accessibility (Section 508), role-based dashboards

10. Demo site: a citizen opening /compliance

The page refuses, and the demo site's API answers 403 to a citizen on all 15 staff routes.

